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Group hopes to extend trail north

October 6, 2010 - By WARREN SCOTT, Staff writer

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WELLSBURG - With the completion of the Brooke County Pioneer Trail between Wellsburg and Wheeling near, the Brooke County Pioneer Trail Association is looking to extend the trail north to Cross Creek Road.

The Brooke County Commission on Tuesday accepted a bid, at the group's recommendation, of \$241,000 from Lash Paving of Colerain to pave 11,300 feet of the trail from the Wheeling Culvert Plant to Airport Road.

Ruby Greathouse, vice president of the trail association, said the contractor hasn't confirmed a start date, but the group hopes work can begin in the near future.

Commission President Bernie Kazienko noted many have worked for several years to complete the trail. He said once it's completed, it will boost local businesses by allowing trail users from Wheeling to easily access Brooke County.

He added the trail also has provided local residents opportunity for recreation and fitness.

In related business, Greathouse and fellow trail association member Judie Jones and Doug Wayt, president of Ohio Valley Trail Partners, a group that promotes trail use throughout the region, asked the commission to consider supporting its application for a grant that would help the groups to extend the trail north from Wellsburg's Yankee Trail.

The Brooke County trail joins the Wellsburg trail at the Buffalo Creek Bridge at the city's south end. The trail groups have suggested the Brooke County trail could resume near the Wellsburg trail at the west side of 27th Street.

They have suggested trail users could use an existing pedestrian signal there to cross state Route 2 to the east side of 27th Street, where the trail would continue on to 30th Street and state Route 2 before Cross Creek Road, with concrete barriers separating trail users from the highway.

The groups want ultimately to connect the trail to a series of Pennsylvania trails extending hundreds of miles from Western Pennsylvania to Washington, D.C., and interrupted only by a gap of about a mile on the Montour Trail. But they haven't determined yet where that connection may occur.

The groups also await approval from Wellsburg City Council to extend the trail through the city.

Wayt said the groups haven't determined yet the amount of the state grant it will seek for the project.

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The commission provided the \$75,000 match required for the grant. The trail association agreed to reimburse that and thus far has raised \$57,500.

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